Internet Browser Policy

Effective Date:
January 16, 2026

Category:
Software

Scheduled Review:
January 2027

1. Authority

Executive Order 2016-06, Enterprise Information Technology Governance

2. Document Control

This document replaces, in its entirety, the *Internet Browser Policy*, dated January 6, 2025.

3. Purpose

This Information Technology Policy (ITP) establishes enterprise-wide policy for internet browser technology.

4. Scope

This policy applies to all offices, departments, boards, commissions, and councils under the Governor's jurisdiction and any other entity connecting to the Commonwealth Network (hereinafter referred to as "agencies").

5. Policy

For definitions of terms found within this document, refer to the *IT Policy Glossary*.

The acceptable use of internet browsers is governed by *Management Directive 205.34 Amended, Commonwealth of Pennsylvania Information Technology Acceptable Use Policy*.

5.1 Workstation Internet Browsers

Agencies shall adhere to the current standards for workstation internet browsers as identified in the *Internet Browser Standard*.

Patches shall be applied in accordance with the *IT Resources Patching Policy.*

Agencies shall ensure that all internet traffic is directed through the Commonwealth's Internet Access Control and Content Filtering implementation in compliance with the *Firewall Policy.*

Agencies shall test and verify that all line-of-business applications are compatible with the current

internet browser standards before upgrading to those standards.

Agencies shall block incognito and private browsing at the client machine level.

5.2 Mobile Internet Browsers

Agencies shall adhere to the current standards for mobile internet browsers as identified in the *Internet Browser Standard*.

5.3 Agency Optional Browsers

Internet browsers listed as Agency Optional in the *Internet Browser Standard* may be used by agencies to meet business requirements. If an agency chooses to deploy the browsers listed in Agency Optional, the agency assumes all risk and responsibility.

Agencies shall maintain and update the browser software patches to the current stable versions to protect from potential vulnerabilities. To stay up to date with security alerts and vulnerability notifications, agencies shall subscribe to and monitor cybersecurity advisories published by the *Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA)*.

Agencies shall adhere to the *IT Resources Patching Policy* for patching of Agency Optional browsers.

Agencies shall evaluate and test for both enterprise and agency application or service compatibility prior to deploying these technologies.

Agency Optional browsers' licenses shall be reviewed along with the intended purpose of the software product. This review shall be accomplished internally at each agency.
Obtaining legal counsel review is necessary to assess the impact of the license provisions and how the agency may enter into the licensing agreement. Agencies shall ensure that adequate legal review has been performed, and an agreement is in place prior to clicking through or otherwise agreeing to any license agreement. This ensures the proper license risks have been assessed, and any distribution or other substantive licensing conditions have been, and can continue to be, met.

6. Contact

Questions or comments may be directed via email to OA, IT Policy.

7. Exception from Policy

In the event an agency chooses to seek an exception from this policy, a request for a policy exception shall be submitted via the IT policy exception process. Refer to *IT Policy Governance* for guidance.

8. Revision History

This chart contains a history of this publication's revisions. Redline documents outline the revisions and are available to Commonwealth users only during the drafting process.

Version	Date	Purpose of Revision
Original	01/06/2025	Base Document
Revision	01/16/2026	Minor grammatical updates and clarifications